

Accounting

Accounting is the language of business. It is difficult to imagine an organization or an individual that is not affected in some way by accounting. From the local corner store to the world's largest corporation, businesses use accounting to organize, understand, and communicate all aspects of their financial position. Ultimately, it is this understanding that helps people make wise business decisions. The integration of information technology and accounting software throughout the accounting curriculum will help prepare students for today's business environment. Students who learn not only the fundamentals of accounting, but how to think and apply that knowledge, will have the confidence to integrate accounting principles and practices into their work in a wide spectrum of careers.

Strands

Financial Accounting Fundamentals, Grade 11, University/College Preparation

- Fundamental Accounting Practices
- Advanced Accounting Practices
- Internal Control, Financial Analysis, and Decision Making
- Ethics, Impact of Technology, and Careers

Accounting Essentials, Grade 11, Workplace Preparation

- Fundamentals of Accounting for Business
- The Accounting Cycle
- Internal Control, Banking, and Computerized Accounting
- Decision Making, Ethics, and Careers

Financial Accounting Principles, Grade 12, University/College Preparation

- The Accounting Cycle
- Accounting Practices for Assets
- Partnerships and Corporations
- Financial Analysis and Decision Making

Accounting for a Small Business, Grade 12, Workplace Preparation

- Service and Merchandising Businesses
- Accounting Practices
- Fixed Assets, Payroll, and Income Tax
- Ethical Issues, Budgets, and Business Expansion

Accounting Essentials, Grade 11, Workplace Preparation

(BAI3E)

This course introduces students to the accounting cycle of a service business. Students will use computer applications software to record business transactions and to prepare financial statements. Students will also investigate banking and cash management, decision making, ethical behaviour, and career opportunities in the field of accounting.

Prerequisite: None

Fundamentals of Accounting for Business

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- describe the nature of accounting and explain its importance in managing a business;
- analyse the different types of business ownership;
- describe the differences among various sources of financing available to businesses.

Specific Expectations

The Nature of Accounting

By the end of this course, students will:

- explain the role of accounting in a service business;
- identify the elements of an accounting system (e.g., journal, ledgers, forms, statements) and describe the benefits of each;
- explain the need for Generally Accepted Accounting Principles (GAAP).

Types of Business Ownership

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify the different types of business ownership (e.g., sole proprietorship, partnership, corporation, cooperative);
- explain the advantages and disadvantages of each type of business ownership;
- examine different businesses to identify their type of ownership.

Sources of Financing

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify the sources of funds available to finance a service business (e.g., family, investors, banks, government);
- describe the purpose of collateral in securing financing;
- identify the costs of different sources of financing for the operation of a service business (e.g., interest on loans, costs of leasing).

The Accounting Cycle

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- describe the accounts for a service business;
- apply the appropriate procedures at each stage of the accounting cycle for a service business;
- apply accounting procedures for sales tax for a service business.

Specific Expectations

The Accounts for a Service Business

By the end of this course, students will:

- explain the relationship among the classifications used in a balance sheet (i.e., assets, liabilities, and owner's equity);
- describe the relationship between debits, credits, and the balance sheet;
- explain the relationship among the classifications used in an income statement (i.e., revenues and expenses).

The Accounting Cycle for a Service Business

By the end of this course, students will:

- record transactions using the double-entry accounting system;
- post transactions to ledger accounts;
- explain the purpose of and prepare a trial balance;
- prepare the financial statements, using a worksheet;
- prepare adjusting entries, closing entries, and a post-closing trial balance.

Sales Taxes for a Service Business

By the end of this course, students will:

- describe the accounting practices particular to sales tax;
- record transactions relating to provincial sales tax;
- record transactions relating to federal sales tax;
- complete provincial and federal sales tax remittance forms.

Internal Control, Banking, and Computerized Accounting

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- demonstrate an understanding of the importance of proper internal control;
- apply the recording and reporting procedures for banking and cash management;
- use accounting or applications software to complete the accounting cycle for a service business.

Specific Expectations

Internal Control

By the end of this course, students will:

- describe the basic elements of a proper internal control system (e.g., petty cash system, separation of duties, receipt and payment procedures, rotation of staff);
- reconcile the daily sales with the point-of-sales records;
- record the transactions related to petty cash.

Banking and Cash Management

By the end of this course, students will:

- describe various bank services available to a service business (e.g., chequing account, current account, line of credit, overdraft);
- complete the forms necessary for a business deposit to a bank;
- explain and prepare a bank reconciliation;
- record the transactions initiated by the bank reconciliation process.

Computerized Accounting

By the end of this course, students will:

- describe the advantages of using accounting software;
- use accounting software to record and post transactions;
- use a computerized trial balance to demonstrate the accuracy of accounting records;
- use accounting or applications software to prepare income statements, balance sheets, adjustments, closing accounting entries, and a post-closing trial balance.

Decision Making, Ethics, and Careers

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- describe how accounting information is used to help in decision making;
- explain the importance of ethics in accounting and in business in general;
- demonstrate an understanding of career opportunities in accounting.

Specific Expectations

The Use of Accounting Information to Make Decisions

By the end of this course, students will:

- describe the use of accounting information in decision making by company personnel (e.g., department managers, owners);
- describe the use of accounting information in decision making by individuals and institutions outside the company (e.g., governments, investors, banks);
- describe the effect on a business of cost changes that are beyond the control of the business (e.g., an increase in taxes, minimum wage, cost of insurance).

Ethics

By the end of this course, students will:

- explain the role of ethics in accounting-related practices (e.g., releasing accurate financial information, observing securities regulations, using company funds for private purposes);
- assess the consequences of unethical behaviour on an employee (e.g., demotion, loss of employment) and on a business (e.g., fines, loss of shareholder confidence);
- identify important elements of a code of ethics (e.g., regulations regarding company assets, policies relating to equity and diversity, use of confidential information, acceptance of gifts).

Career Opportunities

By the end of this course, students will:

- describe the challenges and benefits of a variety of accounting careers;
- describe the role and responsibilities of professional associations with respect to accounting careers;
- identify educational requirements of various accounting and financial careers.